

BEN LAUFER

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Claritas

AI Data Scientist

Los Angeles, CA

Mar 2025 - Present

- Built a similarity-search workflow over precomputed household embeddings that eliminated roughly one week of per-audience data science work while matching existing XGBoost models across ROC AUC and lift
- Engineered Databricks pipelines that transformed 3T+ web events into website-category labels and user-intent features using LLM-based classification; adding these features to existing audience models improved ROC AUC by approximately 8%
- Trained a variational autoencoder on 500+ behavioral features from 114M U.S. households, producing fixed 64-dimensional embeddings for scalable audience matching
- Built the LLM service for an enterprise product that helps marketing teams draft OKRs and plan sprints, used by 300+ monthly active users and saving an estimated five hours per user per quarter; owned the retrieval system, data pipelines, and LLM evaluation framework

F5

Graduate Data Science Consultant

San Luis Obispo, CA

Dec 2024 - Mar 2025

- Led a four-person team analyzing multi-million-row customer histories with survival analysis, identifying customer segments with up to 65% higher churn risk than baseline groups
- Built a KNN churn model using tenure and engagement time-series data to estimate months until churn and assign Low/Moderate/High risk tiers; presented findings and retention recommendations to F5 stakeholders

Postal.io (Acquired by Sendoso)

Data Science Intern

San Luis Obispo, CA

Dec 2023 - Jul 2024

- Web-scraped firmographic data for 365+ customers and combined it with millions of Amplitude and NetSuite records; modeled MRR and rolling-12-month GMV with linear regression to identify high-value segments
- Developed a Red/Yellow/Green lead-scoring framework using industry, financing round, and acquisition count to prioritize prospects; presented the resulting ideal customer profile to executive leadership

Westat

Statistical Consultant

San Luis Obispo, CA

Apr 2024 - Jun 2024

- Collaborated with Westat to analyze self-reported COVID-19 testing among 33K+ U.S. blood donors using logistic regression; identified significant differences across demographic, regional, and vaccination groups
- Presented model findings and recommendations to research stakeholders, translating technical results into clear insights for the study team

California Polytechnic State University

Research Lead

San Luis Obispo, CA

Nov 2023 - Jun 2024

- Co-developed an online coursebook for introductory statistics with R widgets and automated feedback
- Analyzed engagement across 150+ surveys using mixed-effects models; presented findings at eCOTS 2024

EDUCATION

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

M.S. Business Analytics, GPA: 4.0/4.0

Aug 2024 - Jun 2025

B.S. Statistics

Sep 2020 - Jun 2024

SKILLS

Core: Python (Scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, PySpark, Streamlit, Dash), R, SQL, SAS

Tools: AWS (S3, Glue, Athena, SageMaker), Databricks, Tableau, MongoDB

Machine Learning: Feature Engineering, Model Evaluation (Precision, Recall, AUC-ROC), Supervised Learning (logistic regression, XGBoost, DNN), Unsupervised Learning (K-Means)